"Types of democracy!"

"Yes, there are various types of democracy in practice around the world. Among those, **direct democracy** and **representative democracy** are the most popular forms of government."

DO YOU KNOW?

The birth place of democracy is Greece.

Democracy is a term derived from two the Greek words "Demos" and cratia". 'Demos' means the people and 'Cratia' means the power or rule.

"What is Direct Democracy?" asked Sirajudeen.

"In a Direct Democracy, people have the power to frame laws. If we consider your Sports Club as an example, you all can discuss and amend laws and rules. The perspective of each member is considered and each one expresses his view. But how will you take a final decision?"

"The choice of the majority will be accepted. The others will also give their consent," said Selva.



In a Direct Democracy, only the citizens can make laws. All changes have to be approved by the citizen. The politicians only rule over parliamentary procedure. **Switzerland** has had a long history of a successful direct democracy.

HOTS

Is it possible to practise Direct Democracy in India?

"Yes, this system is actually known as Direct Democracy," said Rajasekaran.

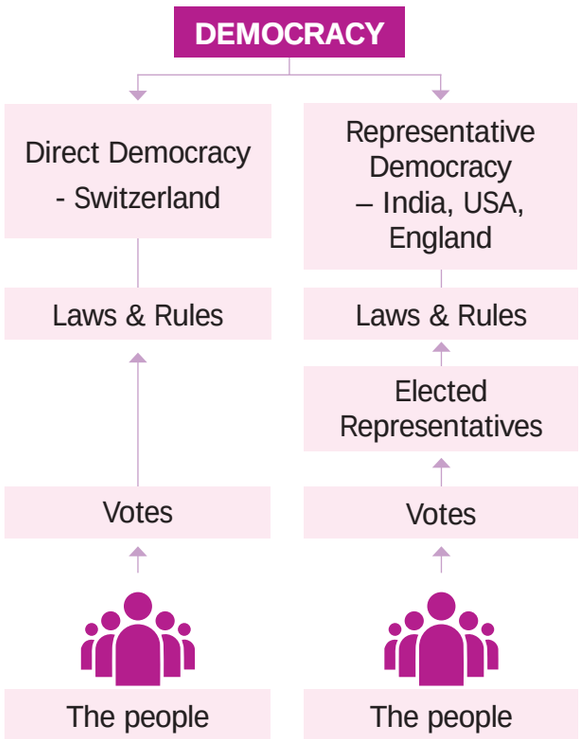
"What do you mean by Representative Democracy?"

"Imagine that your Sports Club has more number of members now. Is it possible for hundreds of them to gather and discuss to take various decisions?"

"No sir"

"In that case, all the members should be represented by a group of representatives, shouldn't they?"

"Yes," agreed the students in union.



"Those group members will administrate the sports club on behalf of all the other members. To select these representatives, elections are held. For example, many contest for the post of the Head, Secretary, Treasurer and members of the administration group.

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